SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

22 July 2022 · Shift 1

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Every time he tried to eat with a chopstick he failed to do _____.

(A) so
(B) it
(C) that
(D) this

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Eternity

(A) Moment
(B) Flash
(C) Purity
(D) Forever

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The _____ for this distance will be ninety cents.

(A) flair
(B) flower
(C) fair
(D) fare

Q.4

Select the option which has no spelling error. The roll of the Union goverment is technical.

(A) The role of the Union goverment is tecnical.
(B) The rolle of the Union government is technnical.
(C) The role of the Unioun goverment is technical.
(D) The role of the Union government is technical.

Q.5

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Rational

(A) Illogical
(B) Polite
(C) Conscious
(D) Impatient

Q.6

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The life history of a person written by himself

(A) Fable
(B) Autobiography
(C) Manuscript
(D) Anecdote

Q.7

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The books “has become enormously” popular with students who do not like to read.

(A) have become enormous
(B) No improvement required
(C) have became enormously
(D) have become enormously

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Relentless

(A) Tenacious
(B) Determined
(C) Yielding
(D) Swarming

Q.9

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Desert flowers bloom “whenever it raining,” and the sight can be rewarding.

(A) whenever it rains
(B) No improvement required
(C) when it rained
(D) when its raining

Q.10

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. The global pandemic remind us that even local censorship can have global consequences.

(A) can have global consequences
(B) The global pandemic remind us
(C) that even local censorship
(D) No error

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. _____ you don’t want to sleep, then leave this room.

(A) As
(B) If
(C) So
(D) Whether

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Leave no stone unturned

(A) To act in a strange manner
(B) Make all possible efforts
(C) To get fired from the job
(D) Not willing to accept the ideas of others

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. It was raining heavily, that’s why your father _____ at my place last night.

(A) delayed
(B) peddled
(C) stayed
(D) berated

Q.14

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. There is no denying / that our country is in / an major economic slump.

(A) that our country is in
(B) There is no denying
(C) an major economic slump
(D) No error

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. They are “perceptive” observers of social groups.

(A) Conflicted
(B) Astute
(C) Imbecile
(D) Witless

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An unconventional style of living

(A) Martyr
(B) Bohemian
(C) Stoic
(D) Cynic

Q.17

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Crater
(B) Mantle
(C) Volkano
(D) Earthquake

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A pipe dream

(A) An illusory plan
(B) A secret
(C) A realistic dream
(D) A clever strategy

Q.19

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer.
Telecom is one of Indias globally recognised success stories.

(A) recognised success stories
(B) Telecom is one of
(C) No error
(D) Indias globally

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who dislikes art and culture

(A) Expert
(B) Philistine
(C) Mercenary
(D) Professional

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Heat exhaustion can be a recreational hazard, (1) _____ for athletes playing sports outdoors (2) _____ wearing heat-trapping clothing and gear when temperatures are high, (3) _____ as the case in American football. Small studies (4) _____ aimed to design more (5) _____ football uniforms.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) casually
(B) individually
(C) especially
(D) radically

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Heat exhaustion can be a recreational hazard, (1) _____ for athletes playing sports outdoors (2) _____ wearing heat-trapping clothing and gear when temperatures are high, (3) _____ as the case in American football. Small studies (4) _____ aimed to design more (5) _____ football uniforms.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) Since
(B) While
(C) Instead
(D) otherwise

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Heat exhaustion can be a recreational hazard, (1) _____ for athletes playing sports outdoors (2) _____ wearing heat-trapping clothing and gear when temperatures are high, (3) _____ as the case in American football. Small studies (4) _____ aimed to design more (5) _____ football uniforms.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) Rather
(B) So
(C) Such
(D) That

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Heat exhaustion can be a recreational hazard, (1) _____ for athletes playing sports outdoors (2) _____ wearing heat-trapping clothing and gear when temperatures are high, (3) _____ as the case in American football. Small studies (4) _____ aimed to design more (5) _____ football uniforms.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Have
(B) Will
(C) Has
(D) Did

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Heat exhaustion can be a recreational hazard, (1) _____ for athletes playing sports outdoors (2) _____ wearing heat-trapping clothing and gear when temperatures are high, (3) _____ as the case in American football. Small studies (4) _____ aimed to design more (5) _____ football uniforms.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) wretched
(B) sheltered
(C) miserable
(D) breathable

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No electron is a proton. No proton is a neutron. Conclusions: I) It is possible for some electrons to be neutrons. II) All neutrons are electrons.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow

Q.2

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (1056, 11, 16) (480, 10, 8)

(A) (88, 2, 7)
(B) (110, 3, 6)
(C) (384, 8, 4)
(D) (90, 3, 5)

Q.3

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 1, 3, 17, 55, ?, 179, 265, 375

(A) 169
(B) 157
(C) 91
(D) 105

Q.4

Five people, L, M, N, R and S are sitting in a straight row, facing north, but not necessarily in the same order. Only M sits between L and S. N sits to the immediate right of S. R sits to the immediate left of L. Who sits at the second position from the left end?

(A) L
(B) S
(C) M
(D) R

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. OMP : QPT :: FOR : ?

(A) HSV
(B) HRU
(C) HRV
(D) HSU

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and sixth number is related to the fifth number. 33 : 101 :: 39 : ? :: 35 : 107

(A) 117
(B) 119
(C) 113
(D) 115

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Doctor : Diagnosis :: Painter : Painting :: Judge : ?

(A) Judgement
(B) Lawyer
(C) Court
(D) Punishment

Q.10

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All P's are M. II. Some Q's are P. Conclusions: I. Some M's are Q. II. Some P's are Q. III. Some M's are P.

(A) Both conclusions I and III follow.
(B) Only conclusion III follows.
(C) Conclusions I, II and III follow.
(D) Only conclusion II follows.

Q.12

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. MN, NM, OL, PK, ?

(A) LQ
(B) QJ
(C) KJ
(D) JK

Q.13

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 6, 11, 21, 41, 81, ?

(A) 241
(B) 151
(C) 161
(D) 240

Q.14

Which two numbers (NOT digits) should be interchanged to make the following equation mathematically correct? 8 ÷ 2 × 6 – 11 + 5 = 15

(A) 2 and 8
(B) 5 and 6
(C) 2 and 6
(D) 6 and 11

Q.15

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. WOR : WSZ :: CLW : ?

(A) BPF
(B) BOF
(C) BOE
(D) BPG

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'PINK' is coded as '25', and 'HEAR' is coded as '16'. How will 'FAIL' be coded in that language?

(A) 28
(B) 14
(C) 24
(D) 12

Q.17

What will be the value of the following expression, if '+' and '×' are interchanged and '–' and '÷' are interchanged? 9 + 2 ÷ 5 × 4 – 2 = ?

(A) 4
(B) 12
(C) 3
(D) 15

Q.18

The ages of seven colleagues are compared. Pawan is older than only Lalit and Kunal. Jatin is the oldest. Manish is younger than only Jatin. Nilesh and Ojha are older than Pawan. Who is the third youngest colleague?

(A) Pawan
(B) Nilesh
(C) Ojha
(D) Kunal

Q.19

Five friends are sitting on a bench in a playground and facing north (but not necessarily in the same order) . Swati is to the immediate left of Rakhi and to the immediate right of Bindia. Meenal is to the right of Rakhi. Tina is exactly between Rakhi and Meenal.Who is sitting at the rightmost end?

(A) Tina
(B) Meenal
(C) Swati
(D) Rakhi

Q.21

In a certain code language, 'GREAT' is coded as '96321', and 'TALMN' is coded as '12457'. How will 'REALM' be coded in that language?

(A) 63249
(B) 63247
(C) 63245
(D) 62349

Q.24

In a certain code language, '95784' is written as 'EGYPT', and '23614' is written as 'LIKRT'. How will '462893' be written in that language?

(A) ELIYPG
(B) TILGPY
(C) EKLYPT
(D) TKLPEI

Q.25

In a certain code language, 'TYRE' is written as 'UZQD' and 'SALE' is written as 'TBKD'.How will 'DISH' be written in that language?

(A) EJRG
(B) EIIH
(C) EJIG
(D) CIRI

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

What was the capital of the Satavahana Dynasty (60 BC - 225 AD)?

(A) Pratishthana
(B) Vidisha
(C) Patliputra
(D) Vanji

Q.2

Which fundamental right provided in Indian Constitution prohibits traffic in human beings and forced labour?

(A) Right to freedom
(B) Right to constitutional remedies
(C) Right to equality
(D) Right against exploitation

Q.3

Which of the following is an example of sedimentary rocks?

(A) Granite
(B) Sandstone
(C) Marble
(D) Basalt

Q.5

Who used the ancient texts to suggest that widows could remarry?

(A) Narayan Guru
(B) Pandita Ramabai
(C) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(D) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Q.6

In India, social groups which are most vulnerable to poverty are _____. I. Scheduled Caste households II. Scheduled Tribe households

(A) Neither I nor II
(B) Both I and II
(C) Only II
(D) Only I

Q.7

Which of the following determines the colour, texture, chemical properties, mineral, content, and permeability of the soil?

(A) Parent rock
(B) Time
(C) Relief
(D) Climate

Q.8
Name the ICC Women Cricketer of the year in 2021.

(A) Harmanpreet Kaur
(B) Mithali Raj
(C) Smriti Mandhana
(D) Jhulan Goswami

Q.9
Which of the following are situated in the nucleus of a cell?

(A) Chromosome and genes
(B) Cytoplasm and chromosome
(C) Nucleolus and cytoplasm
(D) Protoplasm and chromosome

Q.10
Which of the following is the state of origin of the Sattriya dance form?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Assam
(D) Manipur

Q.11
In which state of India are Buddhist cave temples, Barabar Caves, located?

(A) West Bengal
(B) Sikkim
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Bihar

Q.12
Mando festival is related to which state of India?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Karnataka
(C) Bihar
(D) Goa

Q.13
As per Census 2011, which of the following is the correct range of population of India?

(A) 1.2–1.3 billion
(B) 0.5–0.6 billion
(C) 3.0–3.1 billion
(D) 2.0–2.1 billion

Q.14
Bessie Award is a dance award given in which country?

(A) Germany
(B) Norway
(C) Australia
(D) USA

Q.15
Indian Railways ferries which of the following commodities the most as per tonnage, as of April 2022?

(A) Cement
(B) Food grains
(C) Coal
(D) Steel

Q.16
S Balachander is famous for playing the _____.

(A) sitar
(B) veena
(C) violin
(D) flute

Q.17
Who is the author of the novel, God of Small Things?

(A) Vikram Seth
(B) Pankaj Mishra
(C) Kiran Desai
(D) Arundhati Roy

Q.18

Which of the following statements is correct? I. Rolling friction is greater than the sliding friction. II. The frictional force exerted by fluids is called drag.

(A) Only I is correct
(B) Neither I nor II is correct
(C) Both I and II are correct
(D) Only II is correct

Q.19

The tertiary sector of Indian Economy is related to _____.

(A) manufacturing sector
(B) agriculture and related sectors
(C) electricity and coal
(D) transport, communication and business/services

Q.20

Rama is suffering from chickenpox. What type of disease is it?

(A) Fungal disease
(B) Hereditary disease
(C) Viral disease
(D) Bacterial disease

Q.21

Which Indian movement was started to look into the problems of indigo planters in the year 1917?

(A) Champaran Satyagraha
(B) Non-Cooperation Movement
(C) Kheda Satyagraha
(D) Ahmedabad Mill Strike

Q.22

Which of the following persons was a slave-generals of Alauddin Khalji (1296-1316 AD)?

(A) Malik Kafur
(B) Ulugh Khan
(C) Jauna Khan
(D) Nasiruddin Shah

Q.23

Which country will host the 2022 Commonwealth Games?

(A) Australia
(B) Scotland
(C) Canada
(D) England

Q.24

Which Ministry of the Government of India organised ‘Gender Samwaad’ in March 2022?

(A) Ministry of Panchayati Raj
(B) Ministry of Labour & Employment
(C) Ministry of Culture
(D) Ministry of Rural Development

Q.25

Who was the first Indian captain to lift the International Cricket Council (ICC) Cricket World Cup?

(A) Virat Kohli
(B) MS Dhoni
(C) Mohinder Amarnath
(D) Kapil Dev

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) so

SSC's key gives 'so': 'do so' stands for an action just mentioned, here eating with a chopstick, without repeating it, and is the standard form in writing. 'Do it' and 'do that' are also heard, mostly in speech.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Forever

'Eternity' is time without end, which 'forever' also names ('it seemed to take forever'). 'Moment' and 'flash' are brief instants, nearly the opposite.

Q.3 · Answer (D) fare

A 'fare' is the price paid for a journey. 'Fair' (just, or a market) sounds the same but means something else.

Q.4 · Answer (D) The role of the Union government is technical.

The correct spellings are 'role' (a part or function), 'Union', 'government' and 'technical'; only the last sentence has all of them.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Illogical

'Rational' means based on reason or logic, so its opposite is 'illogical'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Autobiography

An autobiography is the story of a person's life written by that person. A fable is a tale with a moral, a manuscript a handwritten text and an anecdote a short account of an incident.

Q.7 · Answer (D) have become enormously

The plural subject 'the books' takes 'have', which takes the past participle 'become', and the adjective 'popular' is modified by the adverb 'enormously': 'The books have become enormously popular'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Yielding

'Relentless' means never stopping or easing, so its opposite is 'yielding', giving way. 'Tenacious' and 'determined' are close in meaning to 'relentless'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) whenever it rains

Something that happens every time takes the simple present, matching 'bloom': 'Desert flowers bloom whenever it rains'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) The global pandemic remind us

The singular subject 'the global pandemic' takes a singular verb: 'The global pandemic reminds us'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) If

'If' introduces the condition that 'then' answers: 'If you don't want to sleep, then leave this room.' 'Whether' would need 'or not'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Make all possible efforts

To 'leave no stone unturned' is to try every possible way to achieve something.

Q.13 · Answer (C) stayed

Because of the heavy rain he 'stayed' (remained) at my place for the night. 'Peddled' means sold goods from place to place and 'berated' scolded.

Q.14 · Answer (C) an major economic slump

'Major' begins with a consonant sound, so it takes 'a', not 'an': 'a major economic slump'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Astute

'Perceptive' means quick to notice and understand: 'astute'. 'Imbecile' and 'witless' mean foolish.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Bohemian

A bohemian lives in an unconventional way, usually with artistic interests. A martyr suffers or dies for a cause, a stoic bears hardship without complaint and a cynic distrusts other people's motives.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Volkano
The correct spelling is 'volcano', with a 'c'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) An illusory plan
A 'pipe dream' is a hope or plan that is fanciful and will never come true.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Indias globally
The possessive needs an apostrophe: 'India's globally recognised success stories'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Philistine
A philistine is a person who is hostile or indifferent to art and culture. A mercenary works only for money.

Q.21 · Answer (C) especially
'Especially' singles out athletes playing outdoors as the people most at risk.

Q.22 · Answer (B) While
'While' joins two things happening at the same time: playing outdoors while wearing heat-trapping clothing and gear.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Such
'Such as' introduces an example of the hazard: American football, played in heavy protective gear.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Have
The plural subject 'small studies' takes 'have', giving the present perfect 'have aimed'. 'Has' is singular, and 'will' and 'did' would need 'aim'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) breathable
'Breathable' uniforms let air through, the answer to the 'heat-trapping' clothing and gear the passage blames.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows
Both statements are negative, so nothing definite links electrons and neutrons: it is possible that some electrons are neutrons (I follows), but 'all neutrons are electrons' cannot be concluded (II does not).

Q.2 · Answer (D) (90, 3, 5)
In each set the first number is 6 times the product of the other two: $6 \times 11 \times 16 = 1056$ and $6 \times 10 \times 8 = 480$. Likewise $6 \times 3 \times 5 = 90$.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 105
The differences are 2, 14, 38, 50, 74, 86, 110, growing by 12 and 24 in turn: $55 + 50 = 105$, and $105 + 74 = 179$.

Q.4 · Answer (A) L
R sits just left of L, only M sits between L and S, and N sits just right of S: R, L, M, S, N from the left. L is second from the left.

Q.5 · Answer (C) HRV
The letters move +2, +3 and +4: O → Q, M → P, P → T. So F → H, O → R, R → V: HRV.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 119
The second number is 3 times the first plus 2: $33 \times 3 + 2 = 101$ and $35 \times 3 + 2 = 107$. So $39 \times 3 + 2 = 119$.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Judgement
Each pair is a professional and what the work produces: a doctor's diagnosis, a painter's painting and a judge's judgement.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Conclusions I, II and III follow.
The Q's that are P are also M, so some M's are Q (I). 'Some Q's are P' gives 'some P's are Q' (II), and 'all P's are M' gives 'some M's are P' (III).

Q.12 · Answer (B) QJ
The first letters run M, N, O, P, Q and the second N, M, L, K, J: QJ.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 161
Each term is twice the one before minus 1: 41 × 2 – 1 = 81 and 81 × 2 – 1 = 161.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 5 and 6
After interchanging 5 and 6: 8 ÷ 2 × 5 – 11 + 6 = 20 – 11 + 6 = 15.

Q.15 · Answer (A) BPF
Write the first cluster backwards and move its letters +5, +4 and +3: ROW → WSZ. Likewise CLW → WLC → BPF (W + 5 wraps round to B). Keeping W and moving O and R by +4 and +8 also fits the first pair, but gives CPE, which is not offered.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 14
Each code is half the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: PINK = (16 + 9 + 14 + 11)/2 = 25 and HEAR = (8 + 5 + 1 + 18)/2 = 16. So FAIL = (6 + 1 + 9 + 12)/2 = 14.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 15
After interchanging the signs: 9 × 2 – 5 + 4 ÷ 2 = 18 – 5 + 2 = 15.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Pawan
Pawan is older than only Lalit and Kunal, so he is the third youngest; Jatin, Manish, Nilesh and Ojha are all older than him.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Meenal
Bindia, Swati and Rakhi sit in that order; Meenal is to Rakhi's right with Tina between them: Bindia, Swati, Rakhi, Tina, Meenal. Meenal is at the right end.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 63245
Each letter keeps its own digit: G = 9, R = 6, E = 3, A = 2, T = 1 from GREAT, and L = 4, M = 5, N = 7 from TALMN, which confirms T = 1 and A = 2. So REALM = 63245.

Q.24 · Answer (D) TKLPEI
Each digit stands for one letter: 9 = E, 5 = G, 7 = Y, 8 = P, 4 = T, and 2 = L, 3 = I, 6 = K, 1 = R. So 462893 = TKLPEI.

Q.25 · Answer (A) EJRG
The first two letters move forward 1 and the last two back 1: TYRE → UZQD and SALE → TBKD. So DISH → EJRG.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Pratishthana
The Satavahanas ruled from Pratishthana, modern Paithan on the Godavari in Maharashtra. Pataliputra was the Maurya capital and Vanji the Chera capital.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Right against exploitation
Article 23 prohibits traffic in human beings and forced labour, and Article 24 the employment of children under 14 in factories, mines and other hazardous work; together they make up the Right against Exploitation.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Sandstone
Sandstone forms from grains of sand pressed and cemented together, so it is sedimentary. Granite and basalt are igneous rocks and marble is metamorphic.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar cited the ancient texts, notably the Parashara Smriti, to argue that widows could remarry; his campaign led to the Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act of 1856.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Both I and II
NCERT's economics textbook names Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe households as the social groups most vulnerable to poverty; among economic groups it names rural agricultural labour and urban casual labour households.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Parent rock
The parent rock, which weathers to form the soil, decides its colour, texture, chemical properties, mineral content and permeability; climate, relief and time act on what it supplies.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Smriti Mandhana
Smriti Mandhana won the ICC's Rachael Heyhoe Flint Trophy as the Women's Cricketer of the Year for 2021.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Chromosome and genes
The chromosomes, which carry the genes, lie in the nucleus. The cytoplasm is the material outside the nucleus.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Assam
Sattriya was created by the Vaishnava saint Srimanta Sankardeva and grew up in the sattras (monasteries) of Assam.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Bihar
The Barabar Caves, rock-cut chambers of the Mauryan period, are in the Jehanabad district of Bihar; Ashoka's inscriptions in them give them to the Ajivika sect.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Goa
The mando is a Konkani song form of Goa, sung to dancing, and the Mando festival celebrates it.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 1.2–1.3 billion
The 2011 Census counted about 121 crore people, or 1.21 billion, between 1.2 and 1.3 billion.

Q.14 · Answer (D) USA
The Bessies, the New York Dance and Performance Awards, honour dance in New York City; they are named after the dance teacher Bessie Schönberg.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Coal
Coal was by far the largest commodity Indian Railways carried by tonnage when the exam was held (July 2022): in 2021-22 it made up nearly half of all freight loaded, about 653 of 1,418 million tonnes, far ahead of iron ore, cement and food grains.

Q.16 · Answer (B) veena
S. Balachander was a celebrated veena player of Carnatic music.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Arundhati Roy
Arundhati Roy's 'The God of Small Things' won the Booker Prize in 1997.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Only II is correct
Rolling friction is smaller than sliding friction, which is why wheels and ball bearings are used, so I is false. The friction a fluid exerts on a body moving through it is called drag, so II is true.

Q.19 · Answer (D) transport, communication and business/services
The tertiary or service sector covers activities that support production rather than produce goods: transport, communication, trade, banking and other services. Manufacturing and electricity belong to the secondary sector and agriculture to the primary.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Viral disease
Chickenpox is caused by a virus, the varicella-zoster virus.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Champaran Satyagraha
In 1917 Gandhi took up the cause of the peasants of Champaran in Bihar, whom European planters forced to grow indigo. The Kheda Satyagraha and the Ahmedabad mill strike followed in 1918.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Malik Kafur
Malik Kafur, a slave taken in the conquest of Gujarat, became Alauddin Khalji's leading general and led his campaigns into the Deccan and the far south. Ulugh Khan was Alauddin's brother.

Q.23 · Answer (D) England
The 2022 Commonwealth Games were held in Birmingham, England, from 28 July to 8 August 2022.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Ministry of Rural Development
The Ministry of Rural Development held the third 'Gender Samwaad', a virtual event of its Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM) on the mission's work for women, in March 2022, during its Iconic Week around International Women's Day.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Kapil Dev
Kapil Dev led India to the 1983 World Cup, beating the West Indies in the final at Lord's.

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